



Three new Witcher games

CD Projekt Red has announced that the Witcher franchise will get three new games in the future. <https://digit.in/oct22-73>



Twitter multimedia tweet

It will be available on both iOS and Android. Ensure you have the latest version of the Twitter app. <https://digit.in/oct22-74>

a large cloth in his pocket which could be used to simulate movement."

His talents really came in handy during the filming of the film 'Spartacus'. In the film, a sequence showed the actors walking in leg chains. An account of the events that followed states, "The director was all set to return to Italy and restage the scene to capture the sound effects. Jack stepped in and did the whole sequence with footsteps and key chains." Legend has it that his identity was kept under wraps by Universal studios. It was only when his protégés started working for other production houses that this art came to the surface. Thus, came to be the art of sound reproduction that we see being used in films and all other forms of audio-video content these days, with the artist being named after Jack Foley.

WHAT'S THE PROFESSION?

As defined by the University of Silicon Valley, "Foley artists reproduce every day sounds like waves crashing, rain coming down, cars passing by, punches, kicks, wind blowing, doors slamming, and other ambient sounds. This is one small part of the post-production process that creates a film or TV show." The sounds produced by foley artists are subtle, and many might not even pay much heed to them. But, they make a world of difference and are increasingly becoming a part of all forms of content.

So, it is very likely that the film or TV show that you just finished bingeing had a foley artist named in the credits. In modern-day content production, there are three major kinds of foley sound:

1. Feet: This is also popularly known as footfalls or footsteps. Here, the main task of the artist is to recreate an accurately staged sound of footsteps using all sorts of props and surfaces. Artists working in this faction are called foley walkers.



Do I sound like a tree now?
Huh?

- 2. Movement:** As the name suggests, these sounds include the ones produced from acts like a person sitting down and grabbing a wallet from their bag. These sounds mainly act as an enhancer to the scene in which they are being used.
 - 3. Specifics:** These sounds include everything that the other two categories miss out on. Sounds such as those of the roaring of a tiger in a scene or helicopters flying over the heads of the actors in a scene are produced by artists working on specifics.
- However, with the advent of the internet, a whole new avenue has opened up for foley artists to explore in this ever-growing digital world.

NOM NOM NOM

If you already guessed it, then 🍴. However, for the people who didn't, we are talking about ASMR or Autonomous Sensory Meridian Response. The ASMR content industry has seen a big boom with the increased adoption of the internet across the world. Again, for the small fraction of people who do not know what it is here's a short explanation from the experts at Northumbria University –

"The Autonomous Sensory Meridian Response (ASMR) is an intensely pleasant tingling sensation originating in the scalp and neck and is elicited by a range of online video-induced triggers. Many individuals now regularly watch ASMR videos to relax, and alleviate symptoms of stress and insomnia..."

So when push came to shove, the world looked to Foley artists to come in and produce ASMR content for them. Music for video has always been essential. However, for a group of netizens, it



Hey Alfred! Let's record you chewing a burrito!

is a necessity now. Even some podcasts which are centred around story-telling make use of the exceptional skills of Foley artists. Hence, the growing demand for Foley artists. They are paid handsome salaries for accurate reproduction of chewing sounds. Sounds... Enticing? Well, the road to becoming one is not that easy.

WHERE TO APPLY?

Well, it may sound underwhelming, but there is not a defined path that you can take en route to becoming a Foley artist. The best way is to undertake a degree program in film making or video production, wherein you are taught how to use sound to enhance the content that you are producing. From there on, it is really the wild wild west, where the only way ahead is defined by the principle of survival of the fittest. Another good way to get started is to take your favourite pieces of content, stripping them off the audio and then work your way to creating your own sound stage for it. It is a healthy exercise to gauge your passion for the profession while also building a healthy portfolio of your own. The best shot that you have at making it into the industry, be it in the west or on your home ground, is to intern or be an apprentice to a practising Foley artist. It is not just us suggesting this, Jay Peck, who has worked on shows like succession, as published by CareersInFilm, also says the same thing – "You do not need a degree to become a Foley Artist. I don't think there are any schools that offer that. You can get a degree in filmmaking and may have the opportunity there to work on student films, however."